

Joseph White

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Education

Miami University	2026–2027
M.A. in Economics	
Miami University	2022–2026
B.S. in Business Economics, Minor in Mathematics (<i>with honors</i>)	

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Market Design, Health Economics

Working Papers

Inside the Frontier: Ownership Change and Organizational Inertia in Nursing Home Production (with John Bowlblis and Charles Moul)

Health care providers may fail to continuously update clinical and managerial routines, leaving them inside their feasible production frontier. We study this possibility in U.S. nursing homes, where ownership changes create moments of organizational disruption and re-optimization. Using CMS administrative panel data from 2017-2024, we identify facility-level ownership transfers and estimate staffing and quality responses in a staggered-adoption event-study design. Following ownership changes, facilities reduce registered nurse and nurse aide hours, while licensed practical-nurse hours remain largely unchanged. Routine-sensitive quality measures, including catheter use, psychotropic medication use, and urinary tract infections, improve. By contrast, staffing intensive resident outcomes such as pressure injuries, falls, weight loss, and decline in physical functioning show little evidence of broad deterioration. These patterns are consistent with ownership transitions revealing inside-frontier inefficiency: new owners do not necessarily possess superior care technology, but may be more willing to revise stale routines, reduce organizational slack, and move facilities closer to efficient operating practices. The findings suggest that governance disruptions can reshape health care production through routine replacement, with ambiguous implications for resident welfare when input reductions and process-quality improvements occur simultaneously.

Research and Work Experience

Portfolio Management Intern, Nationwide Insurance	2026
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Awards and Honors

Gerald Flueckiger Award, Department of Economics, Miami University, 2026
Awarded to an outstanding economics major with a strong interest in microeconomics.
Excellence Scholarship, Miami University
Undergraduate Honors in Economics, Miami University

Skills

Programming: Python, R, SQL, MATLAB
Software: L^AT_EX, Git/GitHub, Office Suite
Languages: English
Citizenship: United States

Leadership and Activities

Economics Student Advisory Board, Miami University
Phi Gamma Delta, Vice President
Blockchain Club